SSC CGL 2024 Tier-I question paper with answers

9 September 2024 · Shift 3

77 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 23 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/Writeup_Final_Anwerkey_CGLE_2024_T1_191224.pdf

Compare your score: the official 2024 cut-off (Tier-I, all posts except JSO and SI Grade-II), out of 200

UR 153.19 **OBC** 146.26 **EWS** 142.02 **SC** 126.46 **ST** 111.89 **ESM** 69.93 **OH** 113.10 **HH** 64.79 **VH** 102.97 **Other PwD** 45.74

Cut-offs apply to marks normalised across all the exam's shifts, so a raw score on one shift is a rough guide. Source: the official result write-up, https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/NoticeBoards/Result%20Write-up%20CGLE%202024%20Tier%20I_51224.pdf

General Intelligence and Reasoning 16 questions

Q.1

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. CWE:ZFX ::PYT:MDI :: KIL:?

(A) PRO
(B) RTQ
(C) PQO
(D) STQ

Q.2

Which of the following terms will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? MFT, NIS, PLQ, SON, WRJ, ?

(A) BUP
(B) BVD
(C) BUE
(D) RUE

Q.4

Three of the following numbers are alike in a certain way and one is different. Pick the odd one out. (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 36 – 84
(B) 33 – 72
(C) 66 – 154
(D) 72 – 168

Q.7

Which two numbers (not digits) should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? 24 ÷ 3 – 4 × 2 + 6 × 5 +12 = 50

(A) 4 and 3
(B) 5 and 4
(C) 3 and 2
(D) 24 and 12

Q.12

The position of how many letters will remain unchanged if each of the letter in the word 'JANITOR' is arranged in English alphabetical order?

(A) Zero
(B) Three
(C) One
(D) Two

Q.13

Four letter-clusters have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the letter-cluster that is different. Note: The odd one out is not based on the number of consonants/vowels or their position in the letter cluster.

(A) PSUV
(B) BEHI
(C) FIKL
(D) TWYZ

Q.14

Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given series will complete the series. P _ A A _ _ Z A _V _ _ A _ _

(A) ZVPAPZAV
(B) ZPVVAPVZ
(C) VZAAPVPZ
(D) VPZZPVAP

Q.15

Which of the four options will replace the question mark (?) in the following series? XF 11 , YI 15, ZL 19 , AO 23, ?

(A) BR 27
(B) CQ 25
(C) CR 25
(D) BP 26

Q.16

In a certain code language, 'SILK' is written as 'TIML' and 'INSECT' is written as 'IOTEDU'. How will 'CHANGE' be written in that language?

(A) DEIHAO
(B) DOIHAE
(C) DIAOHE
(D) DEIOHA

Q.17

What will come in place of the question mark (?) in the following equation, if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 321 – 371 ÷ 22 + 216 × 6 = ?

(A) 7848
(B) 7884
(C) 8747
(D) 8447

Q.18

In the following number-pairs, the second number is obtained by applying certain mathematical operations to the first number. Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) (12, 145) (9, 82)

(A) (22, 483)
(B) (16, 256)
(C) (14, 197)
(D) (8, 69)

Q.19

In a certain code language, A + B means 'A is the son of B', A – B means 'A is the sister of B', A × B means 'A is the brother of B' and A ÷ B means 'A is the mother of B'. Based on the above, how is T related to P if 'P ÷ Q × R – M + T'?

(A) Brother
(B) Husband
(C) Father
(D) Son

Q.20

Select the number from the given options to complete the series. 35, 38, 43, 50, 59, ___

(A) 68
(B) 70
(C) 62
(D) 78

Q.21

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) (19, 456, 6) (16, 320, 5)

(A) (18, 648, 9)
(B) (14, 210, 5)
(C) (21, 504, 8)
(D) (18, 378, 7)

Q.23

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (34, 47, 62) (119, 142, 167) (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed)

(A) (64, 78, 99)
(B) (48, 65, 82)
(C) (27, 38, 51)
(D) (79, 98, 119)

Q.25

In a certain code language, 'SET' is coded as '37' and 'MIX' is coded as '35'. How will 'WAR' be coded in that language?

(A) 29
(B) 39
(C) 21
(D) 32

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

What is the length of Indian Railways network, according to Railway Yearbook 2019- 20?

(A) 67,956 km
(B) 2,402 km
(C) 63,950 km
(D) 1,604 km

Q.2

Which of the following is the largest crustal plate on Earth with an area of over 103,000,000 km^2?

(A) African plate
(B) South American plate
(C) Eurasian plate
(D) Pacific plate

Q.3

'Nuakhai' is the state festival of:

(A) Odisha
(B) Tamil Nadu
(C) Meghalaya
(D) Bihar

Q.4

Which of the following is a straight-chain alkyl carboxylic acid with the chemical formula $CH_3CH_2CH_2CO_2H$?

(A) Methanoic acid
(B) Ethanoic acid
(C) Propionic acid
(D) Butyric acid

Q.5

Who among the following was the youngest instrumentalist to be awarded the Padma Bhushan, the third highest civilian award of India in 2002?

(A) Ustad Zakir Hussain
(B) Pandit Ravi Shankar
(C) Pandit Bhimsen Joshi
(D) Ustad Bismillah Khan

Q.6

Which Article of the Indian Constitution prohibits providing of any religious instruction in the educational institutions maintained by the State?

(A) Article 29
(B) Article 28
(C) Article 30
(D) Article 31

Q.7

Article 77 of the Indian Constitution deals with the _____.

(A) Vice-President of India
(B) oath of office by the Vice-President
(C) conduct of business of the Government of India
(D) term of office of the Vice-President

Q.8

The Muslim Women (Protection of Rights on Marriage) Act, 2019 deals with subsistence allowance in which of the following Sections?

(A) Section 7
(B) Section 5
(C) Section 4
(D) Section 6

Q.10

In which year was the 'Naye Bharat Ke Sapne' campaign launched by Meta and the Ministry of Women?

(A) 2022
(B) 2021
(C) 2023
(D) 2020

Q.11

Which of the following statements is INCORRECT?

(A) Fats and oils get reduced over time and smell bad.
(B) Antioxidants are added to foods containing fats and oil to prevent oxidation.
(C) Chips manufacturers usually flush bags of chips with Nitrogen to prevent the chips from getting ranicid.
(D) Fats and oils are oxidised, they become rancid.

Q.12

Under which of the following Acts was the power to rule India, transferred from the English East India Company to the British Crown?

(A) Regulating Act 1773
(B) Pitt's India Act 1784
(C) Government of India Act 1858
(D) Charter Act of 1833

Q.13
Which of the following countries won the first men's Asian Hockey Championship trophy?

(A) Japan
(B) China
(C) Pakistan
(D) India

Q.14
Silappathikaram (the Jewelled Anklet), the earliest epic poem in Tamil was written in the 5th - 6th Century CE by _____.

(A) Tolkappiyar
(B) Tirumalisai Alwar
(C) Ilango Adigal
(D) Sittalai Sattanar

Q.15
Which of the following statements is correct?.

(A) The five-year plan focuses mostly on private intervention in the economy.
(B) The five-year plan permits long-term intervention by the government in the economy.
(C) The five-year plan always focused on the growth of the tertiary sector.
(D) A five-year plan always stresses market-oriented activities.

Q.16
In Pradhan Mantri Gramin Awaas yojana, the cost of unit assistance is shared between Central and State Governments in the ratio _____ in plain areas.

(A) 30 : 70
(B) 90 : 10
(C) 60 : 40
(D) 40 : 60

Q.17
Who was the revenue minister during the reign of Akbar?

(A) Todar Mal
(B) Abdul Rahim
(C) Mulla Do-Piyaza
(D) Tansen

Q.18
Hot local wind that flows over north India in summer is known as:

(A) Purga
(B) Loo
(C) Chinook
(D) Mango showers

Q.19
As per the definition of Census of India, a 'marginal worker' is a person who works for:

(A) more than 183 days (or six months) in a year
(B) less than 183 days (or six months) in a year
(C) eight months in a year
(D) 83 days in a year

Q.20
In which of the following states is the Nrityagram, an Odissi dance institution, located?

(A) Karnataka
(B) Tamil Nadu
(C) Kerala
(D) Maharashtra

Q.21
At which Olympics was Kho-Kho featured in an exhibition in the main stadium?

(A) 2008
(B) 2016
(C) 1932
(D) 1936

Q.22
Which of the following goods needs further transformation in the economic process?

(A) Capital goods
(B) Intermediate goods
(C) Finished goods
(D) Consumer durable goods

Q.23
Who among the following devised the system of 'Subsidiary Alliance'?

(A) Lord William Bentinck
(B) Lord Wellesley
(C) Lord Dalhousie
(D) Lord Canning

Q.24
Which of the following is an inactivated (killed) polio vaccine developed in 1952?

(A) HDCV vaccine
(B) Salk vaccine
(C) TAB vaccine
(D) Imvanex vaccine

Q.25
Which of the following personalities is a Padma Shri awardee folk singer from the state of Uttar Pradesh?

(A) Ajita Srivastava
(B) Teejan Bai
(C) Ila Arun
(D) Gurmeet Bawa

Quantitative Aptitude 12 questions

Q.1
A number is first increased by 12% and then increased by 23%. The number, so obtained, is now decreased by 34%. What is the net increase or decrease percent in the original number (nearest to an integer)?

(A) 9% increase
(B) 10% decrease
(C) 9% decrease
(D) 10% increase

Q.3
A stock portfolio consists of four stocks. Stock A represents 20% of the portfolio and has a return of 6%. Stock B represents 30% of the portfolio and has a return of 8%. Stock C represents 20% of the portfolio and has a return of 4%. Stock D represents the remaining 30% of the portfolio and has a negative-return of 5%. What is the average return of the portfolio?

(A) 2.6%
(B) 3.4%
(C) 2.9%
(D) 3.2%

Q.6
A thief noticed a policeman at a distance of 600 metres. The thief started running and the policeman chased him. The thief and policeman are running at speeds of 12 km/h and 15 km/h, respectively. Find the time (in minutes) required for the policeman to catch the thief.

(A) 8
(B) 10
(C) 12
(D) 15

Q.7
What is the perimeter (in cm, rounded off to one decimal place) of the sector of a circle with a radius of 10 cm and of angle 30°? (Use $\pi = 3.14$)

(A) 82.8
(B) 25.2
(C) 20.4
(D) 35.7

Q.9

If 7845K854 is divisible by 11, then what is the value of K?

(A) 9 **(B)** 8

(C) 6 **(D)** 7

Q.13

In a ΔPQR, the bisectors of ∠Q and ∠R meet at point O, inside the triangle. If ∠QOR = 107°, then the measure of ∠P is:

(A) 23° **(B)** 40°

(C) 34° **(D)** 17°

Q.15

If the equations $4x + (k - 2)y + 3 = 0$ and $(k - 2)x + 9y - 5 = 0$ $(k > 0)$ are parallel, then find the value of $k^2 + 6$.

(A) 72 **(B)** 68

(C) 70 **(D)** 64

Q.18

Ramesh has ₹18,000. He deposited ₹7,000 in a bank at the rate of 5% per annum and ₹6,000 in other bank at the rate of 6% per annum simple interest. If he received ₹1,160 as simple interest at the end of one year, then the rate of interest per annum on rest of the capital is equal to:

(A) 10% **(B)** 9%

(C) 8% **(D)** 11%

Q.20

In a clearance sale, a sari whose marked price was ₹10,490 is now sold for ₹9,441. What is the discount percentage on the sari?

(A) 12% **(B)** 10%

(C) 18% **(D)** 15%

Q.21

Two triangles EFG and HIJ are congruent. If the area of ΔEFG is 124 cm^2, then the area of ΔHIJ will be:

(A) 31 cm^2 **(B)** 248 cm^2

(C) 124 cm^2 **(D)** 62 cm^2

Q.23

A pipe can fill an overhead tank in 12 hours. But due to a leak at the bottom, it is filled in 18 hours. If the tank is full, how much time will the leak take to empty it?

(A) 36 hours **(B)** 7.2 hours

(C) 63 hours **(D)** 3.6 hours

Q.25

If the length, breadth, and height of a cuboid is 8 cm, 4 cm, and 6 cm, respectively, then the volume (in cm^3) of the cuboid is:

(A) 192 **(B)** 96

(C) 218 **(D)** 172

English Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1

Identify the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the following sentence and select its correct spelling from the given options. I receieved a parcel in the mail today.

(A) recieved
(B) recived
(C) receaved
(D) received

Q.2

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. An order of law requiring people to remain indoors

(A) Curfew
(B) Check in
(C) Restriction
(D) Limit

Q.3

Which of the following idioms means ‘to steal from a shop’?

(A) Golden opportunity
(B) Five-finger discount
(C) Black sheep
(D) Green thumb

Q.4

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. The tea at this café is best than at the Costa Café in our office.

(A) in our office
(B) at the Costa Café
(C) The tea at this café
(D) is best than

Q.5

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given word. Edible

(A) noxious
(B) noisome
(C) mortal
(D) nutritive

Q.6

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Morbid compulsion to consume alcohol continuously

(A) Maniac
(B) Dipsomania
(C) Kleptomania
(D) Satyromania

Q.7

Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the parts in the correct order to form a meaningful sentence. P. having the opportunity of observing people’s Q. we respect and appreciate their point of views R. the advantage of travelling different places and S. culture, custom and lifestyle, is that

(A) SQPR
(B) PSQR
(C) RQPS
(D) RPSQ

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the bracketed word in the following sentence to fill in the blank. The elaborate syllabi had to be _____(summarised) to make a presentation in the UGC assessment meeting.

(A) recapitulated
(B) expanded
(C) prolonged
(D) lengthened

Q.9

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined group of words. The question papers are placed in the lockers of the school in a way that they “can’t be reached”.

(A) are affable
(B) are irrepressible
(C) are affordable
(D) are inaccessible

Q.10
Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Privilege
(B) Accommodate
(C) Mischievious
(D) Millennium

Q.11
Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. The painting was admired by art enthusiasts from around the world.

(A) Art enthusiasts from around the world have admired the painting.
(B) Art enthusiasts from around the world admired the painting.
(C) The painting was being admired by art enthusiasts from around the world.
(D) The painting has been admired by art enthusiasts from around the world.

Q.12
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Miserable

(A) Restrained
(B) Cheerful
(C) Settled
(D) Melodious

Q.13
Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. Fatima was “at her wits’ end” trying to decide on a serene place for spending the holidays in.

(A) So worried, confused or annoyed that she became unconscious
(B) So calm and composed that she knows what to do next
(C) So worried, confused or annoyed that she does not know what to do next
(D) So worried, confused or annoyed that she insulted others for no reason

Q.14
Select the word segment that can substitute the bracketed word segment correctly and complete the sentence meaningfully. (Each participant have) performed well.

(A) Each participant has
(B) Each participant were
(C) Each participant was
(D) Each participant have been

Q.15
Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. He will be made President by the people.

(A) He will be made President by the people.
(B) By the people, he shall be made the President.
(C) The people will make him President.
(D) People will be making him the President.

Q.16
Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Taut

(A) Torn
(B) Slack
(C) Tight
(D) Flaccid

Q.17
Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Confiscate

(A) Titivate
(B) Restock
(C) Seize
(D) Destroy

Q.18

Select the most appropriate homophone to fill in the blank. He has the _____ to express his thoughts.

(A) write
(B) ride
(C) rite
(D) right

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. There are many factories in the “operative” area of the city.

(A) industrious
(B) mechanical
(C) industrial
(D) serviceable

Q.20

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. I are dancing with my husband at my sister’s wedding.

(A) husband at my
(B) I are dancing
(C) with my
(D) sister’s wedding

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Tea prices in the domestic (1)_____ continue to rule high in the current year despite the expectation of a higher production as compared to the previous year. During the past three months, tea prices have been (2)_____ with the prices of other companies. Unlike last year, tea prices have generally shown (3) _____, when tea prices rose dramatically, this year, prices seem to have (4) _____ at a rather high level. In the subsequent four months, the (5)_____ average price showed a downtrend.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) field
(B) zone
(C) market
(D) area

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Tea prices in the domestic (1)_____ continue to rule high in the current year despite the expectation of a higher production as compared to the previous year. During the past three months, tea prices have been (2)_____ with the prices of other companies. Unlike last year, tea prices have generally shown (3) _____, when tea prices rose dramatically, this year, prices seem to have (4) _____ at a rather high level. In the subsequent four months, the (5)_____ average price showed a downtrend.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) aligning
(B) encountering
(C) favouring
(D) countering

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Tea prices in the domestic (1)_____ continue to rule high in the current year despite the expectation of a higher production as compared to the previous year. During the past three months, tea prices have been (2)_____ with the prices of other companies. Unlike last year, tea prices have generally shown (3) _____, when tea prices rose dramatically, this year, prices seem to have (4) _____ at a rather high level. In the subsequent four months, the (5)_____ average price showed a downtrend.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) an innate
(B) a reduction
(C) an uptrend
(D) an inflow

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Tea prices in the domestic (1)_____ continue to rule high in the current year despite the expectation of a higher production as compared to the previous year. During the past three months, tea prices have been (2)_____ with the prices of other companies. Unlike last year, tea prices have generally shown (3) _____, when tea prices rose dramatically, this year, prices seem to have (4) _____ at a rather high level. In the subsequent four months, the (5)_____ average price showed a downtrend.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) abated
(B) moderated
(C) stabilised
(D) equated

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Tea prices in the domestic (1)_____ continue to rule high in the current year despite the expectation of a higher production as compared to the previous year. During the past three months, tea prices have been (2)_____ with the prices of other companies. Unlike last year, tea prices have generally shown (3) _____, when tea prices rose dramatically, this year, prices seem to have (4) _____ at a rather high level. In the subsequent four months, the (5)_____ average price showed a downtrend.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) yearly
(B) monthly
(C) half yearly
(D) weekly

Answer key

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(B)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(B)**
Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.25 **(B)**		

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(B)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(A)**

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.13 **(C)**
Q.15 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.25 **(A)**

English Comprehension

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Explanations

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (B) RTQ

In each pair the positions of matching letters add up to 29: C(3)→Z(26), W(23)→F(6), E(5)→X(24), and P→M, Y→D, T→I likewise. So K(11)→R(18), I(9)→T(20) and L(12)→Q(17): RTQ.

Q.2 · Answer (C) BUE

First letters move +1, +2, +3, +4, +5 (M, N, P, S, W, so next B); second letters +3 (F, I, L, O, R, so U); third letters −1, −2, −3, −4, −5 (T, S, Q, N, J, so E): BUE.

Q.4 · Answer (B) 33 – 72

In 36 – 84, 66 – 154 and 72 – 168 the two numbers are in the ratio 3 : 7. 33 × 7/3 = 77, not 72, so 33 – 72 is the odd one.

Q.7 · Answer (D) 24 and 12

Interchanging 24 and 12: 12 ÷ 3 – 4 × 2 + 6 × 5 + 24 = 4 – 8 + 30 + 24 = 50.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Zero

JANITOR in alphabetical order is A I J N O R T. Position by position (J/A, A/I, N/J, I/N, T/O, O/R, R/T) no letter stays where it was.

Q.13 · Answer (B) BEHI

In PSUV, FIKL and TWYZ the letters move +3, +2, +1. BEHI moves +3, +3, +1, so it is the odd one.

Q.14 · Answer (A) ZVPAPZAV

With Z, V, P, A, P, Z, A, V in the blanks the series reads PZAAV PZAAV PZAAV: the block PZAAV repeats.

Q.15 · Answer (A) BR 27

First letters run X, Y, Z, A, so next is B; second letters move +3 (F, I, L, O), so next is R; the number rises by 4 (11, 15, 19, 23), so next is 27: BR 27.

Q.16 · Answer (C) DIAOHE

Each consonant moves one letter forward and each vowel stays: SILK → TIML and INSECT → IOTEDU. So CHANGE → DIAOHE.

Q.17 · Answer (D) 8447

After interchanging the signs: 321 + 371 × 22 – 216 ÷ 6 = 321 + 8162 – 36 = 8447.

Q.18 · Answer (C) (14, 197)

The second number is the square of the first plus 1: $12^2 + 1 = 145$ and $9^2 + 1 = 82$. Likewise $14^2 + 1 = 197$.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Husband

P is the mother of Q; Q, R and M are siblings; and M is the son of T. So T is the other parent of P's children: P's husband.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 70

The differences are the odd numbers 3, 5, 7, 9, so the next is +11: 59 + 11 = 70.

Q.21 · Answer (A) (18, 648, 9)

In each set, first × third × 4 = second: 19 × 6 × 4 = 456 and 16 × 5 × 4 = 320. Likewise 18 × 9 × 4 = 648.

Q.23 · Answer (D) (79, 98, 119)

Each set is three consecutive perfect squares minus 2: (34, 47, 62) = 6^2, 7^2, $8^2 – 2$ and (119, 142, 167) = 11^2, 12^2, $13^2 – 2$. Likewise (79, 98, 119) = 9^2, 10^2, $11^2 – 2$.

Q.25 · Answer (B) 39

Each letter takes its position counted from Z (A = 26, B = 25, …, Z = 1) and the code is their sum: SET = 8 + 22 + 7 = 37 and MIX = 14 + 18 + 3 = 35. So WAR = 4 + 26 + 9 = 39.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) 67,956 km

According to the Indian Railways Year Book 2019-20, the network's route length was 67,956 km.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Pacific plate

The Pacific plate, at over 103 million km², is the largest of the Earth's lithospheric plates.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Odisha

Nuakhai, the harvest festival at which the new rice is first offered, is the state festival of Odisha, celebrated mainly in western Odisha.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Butyric acid

$CH_3CH_2CH_2COOH$ has four carbon atoms: butanoic (butyric) acid. Methanoic, ethanoic and propionic acids have one, two and three.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Ustad Zakir Hussain

Tabla maestro Ustad Zakir Hussain received the Padma Bhushan in 2002. Of the others, Bhimsen Joshi was a vocalist, and Ravi Shankar and Bismillah Khan received theirs in the 1960s.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Article 28

Article 28(1) bars religious instruction in any educational institution wholly maintained out of State funds.

Q.7 · Answer (C) conduct of business of the Government of India

Article 77 covers the conduct of business of the Government of India: all its executive action is taken in the President's name.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Section 5

Section 5 of the 2019 Act entitles a Muslim woman against whom triple talaq is pronounced to subsistence allowance for herself and her dependent children.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 2023

Meta launched the 'Naye Bharat Ke Sapne' campaign with the Ministry of Women and Child Development in 2023.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Fats and oils get reduced over time and smell bad.

Fats and oils go rancid because they are oxidised, not reduced, which is why antioxidants are added and chip bags are flushed with nitrogen. So the first statement is incorrect.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Government of India Act 1858

The Government of India Act 1858, passed after the revolt of 1857, transferred the power to govern India from the East India Company to the British Crown.

Q.13 · Answer (D) India

India won the first men's Asian Champions Trophy, held in Ordos, China, in 2011.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Ilango Adigal

Silappathikaram was written by Ilango Adigal; Sittalai Sattanar wrote its sequel, Manimekalai.

Q.15 · Answer (B) The five-year plan permits long-term intervention by the government in the economy.

A five-year plan sets out long-term government intervention in the economy; it is not about private intervention or market-oriented activity alone.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 60 : 40

Under PMAY-G the Centre and the States share the cost of unit assistance 60 : 40 in plain areas, and 90 : 10 in the north-eastern and Himalayan states.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Todar Mal

Raja Todar Mal was Akbar's revenue minister and devised the zabti system of land revenue.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Loo
The Loo is the hot, dry wind of the north Indian plains in May and June. The Chinook blows in North America, and mango showers are pre-monsoon rains in the south.

Q.19 · Answer (B) less than 183 days (or six months) in a year
The Census of India counts as a marginal worker anyone who worked for less than 183 days (six months) of the year; 183 days or more makes a main worker.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Karnataka
Nrityagram, the Odissi dance village founded by Protima Gauri in 1990, is near Bengaluru, Karnataka.

Q.21 · Answer (D) 1936
Kho-kho was shown as a demonstration sport at the 1936 Berlin Olympics.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Intermediate goods
Intermediate goods, such as raw materials and parts, are used up in making other goods, so they still need further transformation; final goods do not.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Lord Wellesley
Lord Wellesley, Governor-General from 1798 to 1805, devised the Subsidiary Alliance.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Salk vaccine
Jonas Salk developed the inactivated (killed) polio vaccine in 1952; Sabin's oral vaccine uses live, weakened virus.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Ajita Srivastava
Ajita Srivastava, a folk singer from Mirzapur, Uttar Pradesh, received the Padma Shri in 2022. Teejan Bai is a Pandavani singer from Chhattisgarh.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 · Answer (C) 9% decrease
1.12 × 1.23 × 0.66 = 0.909, so the number ends about 9.1% below where it started: a 9% decrease to the nearest integer.

Q.3 · Answer (C) 2.9%
Weighted average: 0.2 × 6 + 0.3 × 8 + 0.2 × 4 + 0.3 × (–5) = 1.2 + 2.4 + 0.8 – 1.5 = 2.9%.

Q.6 · Answer (C) 12
The policeman gains 15 – 12 = 3 km/h = 50 m a minute on the thief, so he closes 600 m in 12 minutes.

Q.7 · Answer (B) 25.2
Arc = 2πr × 30/360 = 2 × 3.14 × 10/12 ≈ 5.23 cm. Perimeter = two radii + arc = 20 + 5.23 ≈ 25.2 cm.

Q.9 · Answer (A) 9
For divisibility by 11 the sums of alternate digits must differ by 0 or a multiple of 11. Odd places: 7 + 4 + K + 5 = 16 + K; even places: 8 + 5 + 8 + 4 = 25. 25 – (16 + K) = 0 gives K = 9.

Q.13 · Answer (C) 34°
Where the bisectors of ∠Q and ∠R meet, ∠QOR = 90° + ∠P/2. So 107° = 90° + ∠P/2 and ∠P = 34°.

Q.15 · Answer (C) 70
Parallel lines have proportional x and y coefficients: 4/(k – 2) = (k – 2)/9, so $(k – 2)^2 = 36$ and k = 8 (as k > 0). Then $k^2 + 6 = 70$.

Q.18 · Answer (B) 9%
The first two deposits earn 5% of ₹7,000 + 6% of ₹6,000 = ₹350 + ₹360 = ₹710. The remaining ₹5,000 earned ₹1,160 – ₹710 = ₹450, which is 9%.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 10%
Discount = ₹10,490 – ₹9,441 = ₹1,049, which is 10% of the marked price.

Q.21 · Answer (C) 124 cm²
Congruent triangles are identical in shape and size, so their areas are equal: 124 cm².

Q.23 · Answer (A) 36 hours
The pipe fills 1/12 of the tank an hour, but with the leak only 1/18, so the leak empties 1/12 – 1/18 = 1/36 an hour: 36 hours for a full tank.

Q.25 · Answer (A) 192
Volume of a cuboid = l × b × h = 8 × 4 × 6 = 192 cm³.

English Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (D) received
The correct spelling is 'received' ('i' before 'e' except after 'c').

Q.2 · Answer (A) Curfew
A curfew is an order requiring people to stay indoors, usually between set hours.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Five-finger discount
A 'five-finger discount' is slang for shoplifting.

Q.4 · Answer (D) is best than
Two things are compared, so the comparative is needed: 'is better than', not 'is best than'.

Q.5 · Answer (D) nutritive
'Edible' means fit to be eaten. Of the options only 'nutritive' (nourishing) is close; 'noxious' and 'noisome' mean harmful or offensive.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Dipsomania
Dipsomania is a morbid craving for alcohol; kleptomania is a compulsion to steal.

Q.7 · Answer (D) RPSQ
'The advantage of travelling different places and (R) having the opportunity of observing people's (P) culture, custom and lifestyle, is that (S) we respect and appreciate their point of views (Q).'

Q.8 · Answer (A) recapitulated
To 'recapitulate' is to summarise; 'expanded', 'prolonged' and 'lengthened' mean the opposite.

Q.9 · Answer (D) are inaccessible
Something that cannot be reached is 'inaccessible'.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Mischievious
The correct spelling is 'mischievous', with no 'i' before '-ous'.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Art enthusiasts from around the world admired the painting.
'Was admired by' is simple past passive, so the active is simple past: 'Art enthusiasts from around the world admired the painting.'

Q.12 · Answer (B) Cheerful
'Miserable' means very unhappy; its opposite is 'cheerful'.

Q.13 · Answer (C) So worried, confused or annoyed that she does not know what to do next
To be 'at one's wits' end' is to be so worried or confused that one does not know what to do next.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Each participant has
'Each' takes a singular verb: 'Each participant has performed well.'

Q.15 · Answer (C) The people will make him President.
'Will be made' is the future passive of 'will make': 'The people will make him President.'

Q.16 · Answer (C) Tight
'Taut' means stretched tight: 'tight'. 'Slack' and 'flaccid' are its opposites.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Seize
To 'confiscate' is to take away by authority: to 'seize'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) right
He has the 'right' (the entitlement) to express his thoughts; 'write' and 'rite' sound the same but mean something else.

Q.19 · Answer (C) industrial
An area full of factories is an 'industrial' area; 'industrious' means hard-working.

Q.20 · Answer (B) I are dancing
'I' takes 'am': 'I am dancing'.

Q.21 · Answer (C) market
'Tea prices in the domestic market': prices are set in a market.

Q.22 · Answer (A) aligning
Prices have been 'aligning with', that is moving in line with, the prices of other companies.

Q.23 · Answer (C) an uptrend
'Shown an uptrend' fits the passage's point that tea prices continue to rule high.

Q.24 · Answer (C) stabilised
After last year's dramatic rise, prices this year 'seem to have stabilised', settled, 'at a rather high level'.

Q.25 · Answer (B) monthly
The passage follows prices month by month, so 'the monthly average price'.

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